

Plant Parts & Functions

Use the cue, then fade the cue. Study the cue card for 60 seconds. Then cover it before answering Round 1. Check the card only after you commit to an answer.

CUE FOCUS Each plant part has a job: **roots** take in water and anchor the plant, the **stem** carries water and holds the plant up, **leaves** make food using sunlight, and the **flower** makes seeds to reproduce.

Round 1 — Retrieve It

1. Which plant part takes in water and holds the plant in the ground?

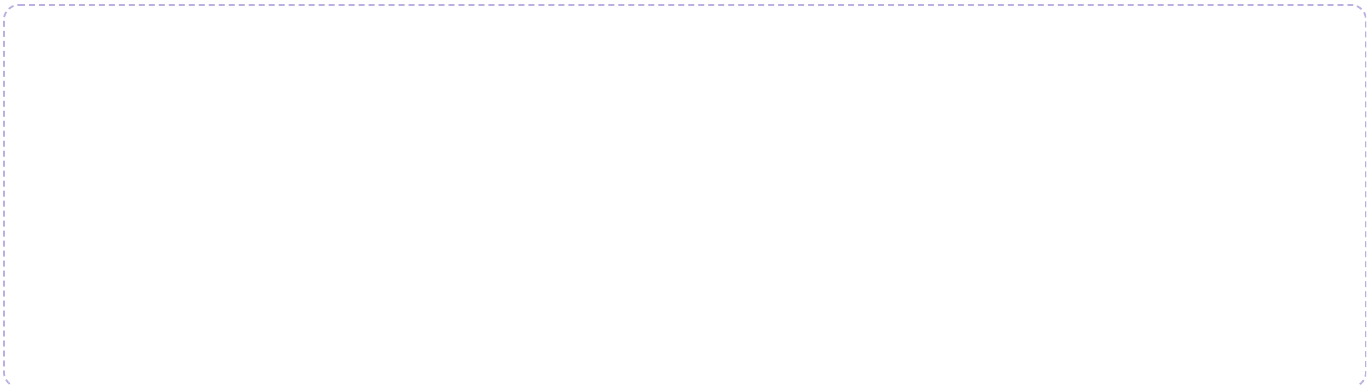
2. Which plant part carries water and holds the plant up?

3. Which plant part makes food using sunlight?

4. Which plant part makes seeds so new plants can grow?

Round 2 — Sketch It

Draw a plant with roots, a stem, leaves, and a flower. Label each part and write its job next to the label.



Plant Parts & Functions — Apply It

Keep the cue card covered. Answer first. Then use the cue to check, revise, and explain what you changed.

Round 3 — Apply the Part

1. A plant is knocked over by the wind and falls flat. Which part was not doing its job, and what does that part normally do?

2. A plant is put in a dark closet for a week and gets weak. Which part could not do its job, and why?

3. A gardener wants a plant to grow more plants next year. Which part does she need the plant to make, and what does that part hold?

Round 4 — Reason from Evidence

A friend says the leaves are what pull water up from the soil. Using what you know about plant parts, is your friend correct? Explain which part really does that job.

Plant Parts & Functions — ACE It

Use the cue card only if you need it. The goal is to show what you can explain, connect, and use on your own.

A

Articulate

Explain how the roots, stem, and leaves work together to keep a plant alive. Follow the water from the ground to the leaves.

C

Connect

Connect one plant part to a part of your own body that does a similar job. Explain why they are alike.

E

Extend

Design a plant that could live in a very dry, sunny place. Describe how its roots, stem, and leaves would be built to help it survive.

Confidence check. Circle one after you finish: I still need the cue / I need it once in a while / I can explain this without it.

Teacher Key — Plant Parts & Functions

Remove this page before student copying. Answers below give expected ideas, not required wording.

Retrieve It

1. The roots (they take in water and anchor the plant).
2. The stem (it carries water and holds the plant up).
3. The leaves (they make food using sunlight).
4. The flower (it makes seeds to reproduce).

Sketch It — look for

All four parts drawn and labeled: roots (take in water/anchor), stem (carries water/holds up), leaves (make food from sunlight), flower (makes seeds).

Apply It

1. The stem; it normally holds the plant up and carries water. (Roots may also be accepted if the plant was uprooted.)
2. The leaves; they need sunlight to make food, and there was no light in the dark closet.
3. The flower; it makes seeds, which can grow into new plants.

Reason from Evidence — look for

The friend is not correct. The roots take in water from the soil and the stem carries it up. Leaves use the water and sunlight to make food; they do not pull water from the ground.

ACE — Extend look-for

A sensible design: deep or wide roots to reach water, a sturdy stem that stores water, and small or waxy leaves to save water while still catching sunlight.

Suggested use. Run Page 1 with the cue card available, Page 2 with the cue mostly covered, and Page 3 as independent reflection. Let students uncover the cue to self-correct in a different color.